of our church. Not that I mean that I would choose for an associate a man who was a puritan (or presbyterian I believe the modern term is) because I have seen amongst them some most sour bigoted misanthropes, who look upon a poor sinner like me who likes his grog, his friend, and his song, as no better than an infidel. Your comparison of the dispute between the clergy about ceremonies was most apt; It resembles much more a Mahomedan dispute than a Christian one. One great cause of dispute between the Mahomedan sects is whether in a certain part of the prayers the arms should be folded over the chest or held straight down by the side!![84] and about this blood has been shed!!

The villages are going on very well, and this year thank God I have heard of no riv[al] thefts except a little stealing of fruit during the season; indeed I have heard of but one bad case. One man stabbed another with a crooked bladed dagger; luckily it glanced off from his ribs only making a deep wound in the side. They went to the cazi (civil court) and the plaintiff received heavy damages which were paid without reference to me so I am not supposed to know any thing about it. Fighting with daggers is very common in this part of Persia but assassination exceedingly rare. The men drink, quarrel, and dare one another to fight. Frequently merely to prove their courage without any previous dispute.

M. d'Ozeroff the Russian Consul Genl has made a sledge and Dr. Cazolani[85] and I went out with him in it the first time. We had two upsets one a most ridiculous one. All three were sent spinning out into the snow. Cazolani, a long thin fellow, and very weak, fell with his head in the snow and his legs in the air, and could not for some time recover himself. Ozeroff drives most furiously, and it reminded me of the way in which my dear Father used to drive down from Hampstead.

Tabreez, April 3, 1845

Of late years English travellers have been very rare in Persia. Before the establishing of the route by Egypt some used to take this way home, instead of going round the Cape. Col Farrant[86] having just passed through reminded me of this. He has been in Persia since '34, but since that time he has been twice in England. He is lately appointed Secretary of Legation to Col Sheil who is now Envoy at Tehran. He is a merry fellow, full of fun and anecdote and never looks at a book. This may be accounted for when I tell you that he belongs to the Indian cavalry. Those cavalry men are many of them in that way. But he is a wonderful judge of a horse and has frequently made large sums by dealing in them. I believe he talks no language well except his own. His Persian is most

84 One of the many minor differences between the Shia and Sunni sects.
85 Apparently a private physician, i.e., not attached to any of the consular staffs.
86 The *British Army List* for 1845 lists Lieut. Col. Francis Farrant on duty in Persia.

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